

THE GETHSEMANE FACTOR

(Blue print is what I want Salena to write on the screen as I preach)

TEXT: Matthew 26:36-46 (NKJV) *“Then Jesus came with them to a place called Gethsemane, and said to the disciples, “Sit here while I go and pray over there.”³⁷ And He took with Him Peter and the two sons of Zebedee, and He began to be sorrowful and deeply distressed.³⁸ Then He said to them, “My soul is exceedingly sorrowful, even to death. Stay here and watch with Me.”³⁹ He went a little farther and fell on His face, and prayed, saying, “O My Father, if it is possible, let this cup pass from Me; nevertheless, not as I will, but as You will.”⁴⁰ Then He came to the disciples and found them asleep, and said to Peter, “What? Could you not watch with Me*

one hour? ⁴¹“Watch and pray, lest you enter into temptation. The spirit indeed is willing, but the flesh is weak.” ⁴²Again, a second time, He went away and prayed, saying, “O My Father, if this cup cannot pass away from Me unless I drink it, Your will be done.” ⁴³And He came and found them asleep again, for their eyes were heavy. ⁴⁴So He left them, went away again, and prayed the third time, saying the same words. ⁴⁵Then He came to His disciples and said to them, “Are you still sleeping and resting? Behold, the hour is at hand, and the Son of Man is being betrayed into the hands of sinners. ⁴⁶“Rise, let us be going. See, My betrayer is at hand.”

INTRO: Verse 36 says, *“Then Jesus came with them to a place called Gethsemane.”* The meaning of the word Gethsemane is “Oil

press.” The very meaning of the word Gethsemane, suggests a place of intense struggle. If Gethsemane is a place of intense struggle, what benefit could there possibly be in a place like that?

Three benefits of Gethsemane:

- Gethsemane is a place of choice....
- Gethsemane is a place of intense struggle...
- Gethsemane is a place of great victory...

I. GETHSEMANE IS A PLACE OF CHOICE...

It was at Gethsemane that Jesus had to make a decision, to take the easy road or submit His will to the will of the Father. Even though Jesus was the Son of God, He had to bring His human will under subjection to the will of the Father, just like all other sons of God!

When teaching his disciples to pray, Jesus said, ***“Thy kingdom come, thy will be done in earth as it is in Heaven.”*** When Jesus arrived at Gethsemane He had to apply what He had been teaching.

We all have opportunities for practical application of submitting our will to the will of the Father! This is not easy but it is necessary!

I am sure that if it had been possible for sin to have been forgiven another way, other than Jesus giving his life, the human part of Jesus would have preferred it. But it was not possible so Jesus had to come to the place of allowing the will of the Father to be the authority.

Hebrews 4:14-15 (NKJV) ***“Seeing then that we have a great High Priest who has passed through the heavens, Jesus the Son of God, let***

us hold fast our confession. ¹⁵For we do not have a High Priest who cannot sympathize with our weaknesses, but was in all points tempted as we are, yet without sin.”

Oftentimes the Gethsemane Factor is the difference between:

- Life and death!
- Good and evil!
- Blessing and cursing!

Matthew 16:24 (NKJV) *“If anyone desires to come after Me, let him deny himself, and take up his cross, and follow Me.”*

- Deny, according to Webster, is “*To refuse, to give in.*” Deny in the Greek means “*To disown or abstain.*”
- Cross in the Greek means “*A pole as an instrument of capital punishment.*”

- Follow in the Greek means “*Exactly, circumspectly, diligently, or perfectly.*”

II. GETHSEMANE IS A PLACE OF INTENSE STRUGGLE...

Jesus himself found Gethsemane to be a place of intense struggle. Luke 22:44 (NKJV) “*Being in agony, He prayed more earnestly. Then His sweat became like great drops of blood falling down to the ground.*” The very meaning of the word “*Gethsemane*” depicts a struggle; the meaning is “*oil press.*”

Ephesians 6:12 (NKJV) “*For we do not wrestle against flesh and blood, but against principalities, against powers, against the rulers of the darkness of this age, against spiritual hosts of wickedness in the heavenly places.*” A closer study of this verse reveals the

writer is speaking of four classifications of demonic forces which are at work in the world today. We are in the struggle of our life, this is not a game! This is war! This is the Gethsemane Factor!

On that night in Gethsemane, if the disciples could have peered into the spiritual world, they would not have gone to sleep; they would have been frightened out of their minds! Our lord was wrestling against all kinds of evil forces! He was in the true sense of the word, having an intense struggle!

In our Christian walk we will encounter times when we will walk through Gethsemane, that place of intense struggle! We have all been there when the light at the end of the tunnel turned out to be an oncoming train! Psalm 23:4

(NKJV) *“Yea, though I walk through the valley of the shadow of death, I will fear no evil; For You are with me. 5 Thou prepares a table before me in the presence of mine enemies: Thou anointest my head with oil; my cup runneth over.”*

Remember God can turn our wilderness into a place where water is standing in pools!

Psalm 84:6 (NKJV) *“Blessed is the man whose strength is in thee; in whose heart are the ways of them. ⁶Who passing through the valley of Baca make it a well; the rain also filleth the pools.”*

The Gethsemane Factor is a place of struggle, but struggle equals growth!

III. GETHSEMANE IS A PLACE OF GREAT VICTORY...

At Gethsemane Jesus won the victory over the

flesh, so that he could submit to the agony of the cross and severe torture at the hands of cruel men! When Jesus was on the cross, all He had to do was to say the word and God would have sent angels to set Him free!

So, it is with us many times, we have to make a choice, struggle with the flesh; get the victory over these things; then fight the battle which has already been won. Yes, the battle against evil has already been won for us, all we have to do is decide to follow Jesus. Romans 8:31 (NKJV)

“What then shall we say to these things? If God is for us, who can be against us?”

For Jesus, Gethsemane became a place of great victory because He made His decision to die on the cross the night before He was crucified!

Hebrews 12:2 (NKJV) ***“Looking unto Jesus,***

the author and finisher of our faith, who for the joy that was set before Him endured the cross, despising the shame, and has sat down at the right hand of the throne of God.”

The Gethsemane factor is a place of tremendous victory!

CONCLUSION:

Here we are Gethsemane today; will this prove to be a place of great victory or defeat in your life?